



AFTER

Raw racial hatred prompted raids against the contraband camps. At the same time, as the Confederate army lost more men, the idea of enlisting enslaved men into the ranks was accepted by the Confederate Congress.

ATTACKS ON CAMPS

Confederate forces **mounted raids on contraband** refugee camps, kidnapping and burning Black men, women, and children. Nevertheless, enslaved people kept seeking freedom behind Union lines. Women such as **Leah Black** in Tennessee, whose husband was murdered by Confederate soldiers, **fed USCT troops** and helped reform Black communities at the camps.

ENLISTING ENSLAVED MEN

Enslaved people were **forced into service** in a variety of tasks by the insurgents throughout the war, and **legislation passed by the Confederate congress** on March 13, 1865, allowed for enslaved Black Americans to be **mustered and equipped** on an experimental basis as **combat soldiers**.